The Australian Effie Awards

PR-Led Entry Form 2015

Entry Number: 17

Agency Leo Burnett Melbourne

Advertiser SPC Ardmona

Entry Title #SPCSunday: How listening saved a hundred year old company

Category for this Entry PR-Led Campaign

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Directions appearing with each question must not to be deleted from the completed case; they serve as a guide for both entrants and judges. Complete entry form in - Type face: black font; 10pt minimum. All data must include a specific, verifiable source. Refer to the Effie "How to Enter" booklet for guidelines on properly sourcing your data. Data without a source will result in entry disqualification. Answer every question or indicate "not applicable" and define your target audience in the entry. Any unanswered question will result in entry disqualification.

Executive Summary (Please Attach the Executive Summary to the front of the entry so the judges can read this first)

An Executive Summary of no more than 100 words is also required (not included in page count).

This campaign didn't follow a traditional planning approach; we didn't have the luxury of time or money. In fact, there was no client brief, just a unique and terrifying set of circumstances facing SPC. This is a demonstration of adaptive planning in action and the impact it had on Australians, the market, retailers, big business and Government. SPC Sunday leveraged a key insight about the people that matter to the SPC brand and a vital cultural tension that played a breakthrough role in saving SPC.

1. Total Campaign Expenditure

Provide total fees and costs associated with the campaign. If the campaign has used any form of paid media, please include this in the campaign expenditure. Including production and value of donated media and non-traditional paid media.

$2,500

2. What was the strategic communications challenge?

What was going on in your category? Provide information on the category, marketplace, company, competitive environment, target audience and/or the product /service that created your challenge and your response to it.

An iconic Australian company under threat of extinction

SPC is a proud, 100 year-old Australian business that has been a part of Australian life for a long time. Everybody grew up with SPC in their pantries. It's a much-loved Australian brand, up there with Vegemite[1]. As the largest fruit processer in the country, the company employs thousands of workers in regional Victoria. However, by early 2014, this iconic brand and the thousands of families that depend on it, were under serious threat.

[1] Agency Research (2014). Quantitative dip into grocery buyer perceptions of SPC brand

A bleak outlook for Australia's beloved brand
Cheap imports were flooding the market, making it virtually impossible for SPC to compete. Consumers seemed to be continuously choosing the cheaper imported alternatives and SPC's Australian grown products were being overlooked[2]. The painful knock-on effect came in the form of declining sales for three consecutive years[3], with share of the Australian canned food market consequently suffering. Farmers were destroying their century-old orchards out of desperation, and thousands of jobs were on the line. Achieving differentiation in the commodity canned product sector with such fierce competition was a huge challenge. After the recent closure announcements from local car manufacturers, Holden and Ford, this situation spelled disaster for Australian manufacturing. SPC was in desperate need of support, yet nobody was willing to help. Even the Prime Minister publicly refused to provide SPC a lifeline, leaving the company and thousands of employees languishing.

Across the nation, people were caring but not acting
As 2014 dawned, SPC's predicament had become a sensitive topic. The company was gearing up for closure. There was a lot of coverage of its plight in the Australian media and via social networks. Unfortunately, although the Australian public had been vocal about the issue, they weren't changing their purchase behaviours.

The challenge: how could we change the public's mentality from just caring about the company's plight, to empowering them to do something about it? We would have to rekindle the country's love for this proudly Australian company and its products. We needed to ignite pride in Australian-made produce and convince people to stop shopping with their wallets and start shopping with their hearts. Adding to the challenge was the reality of a very tight budget. Due to their financial position, SPC had only $2,500 to invest in paid media.

3. What were your objectives? State specific goals.

Your entry is expected to include compelling data including objectives and results for criteria such as reach, tone of voice, message penetration, conversation, sales and ROI. Only in rare instances are the judges likely to award an entry that only demonstrates attitudinal changes. Provide a % or # for all goals. If you do not have a specific type of objective (e.g. no quantifiable objectives), state this in the entry form and explain why and why the objectives you do have are significant and challenging in the context of your category.

As audacious as it sounds, we wanted to help save the company
SPC was set for closure within months. The best chance for survival would be to secure government funding. However, in order to do this, it would be necessary to show that SPC was a company worth saving. We needed to halve the average monthly rate of decline from the previous year from $RSV-13.46 to $RSV-6.73. This was a big ask given that SPC was already deeply embedded in a downward trend with three years of declining sales.

4. What was your strategy – and how did you get there?

What was your strategy? Was it driven by a consumer insight or channel insight or marketplace / brand opportunity? Explain how it originated and how the strategy addressed the challenge.

Social listening affirmed the affinity that Australians had for SPC. That was not the problem. We were up against the reality of shopping behaviour that was inconsistent with people's stated attitudes and beliefs. People consistently expressed that they wanted "Australian made and Aussie grown", yet continued to buy cheaper imports[4]. Our opportunity was to tap into this behavioural inconsistency and turn it into a call to arms.

[2] Euromonitor (2014). *Category Briefing: Canned/Preserved Food in Australia*
[3] SPC sales data (2011-2013). Year-on-year comparison of monthly sales of SPC Ardmona packaged fruit
[4] Roy Morgan Asteroid (2014). *'I try to buy Australian made products as often as possible' – filtered by consumers who usually buy groceries*

The major obstacle was the lack of clout that such a message would have coming from a corporation. Not to mention the lack of budget to support such a message. The silver lining came in the insight that Australians are passionate about getting behind the underdog, especially when the underdog is backed into a corner – those unbeatable odds are what we live for!

A call out to the nation
In order to help save a 100 year old company with 100 years' worth of memories, we had to reach out to the entire nation – the thousands upon thousands of Australians who grew up with (and cherish) the SPC brand. With a media investment of just $2,500, we knew that broadcast communications was not an option. In our view, the opportunity rather lay within social media.

Awakening the sleeping giant of social media
SPC had never been a 'social' brand, with zero social media channels and few online touch points. This was a key consideration in our overall marketing strategy, as we worked on creating a social media presence across Facebook, Twitter and Instagram.

The company's dire circumstances and the government's refusal to help triggered a wave of conversation on social media, which we identified as an opportunity. As an iconic Australian company with its back against the wall, SPC was a 'sleeping giant' in the social media space. To truly awaken its potential, we needed to join the conversation and re-ignite the passion that already existed amongst the Australian public.

5. What was your big idea?

What was the idea that drove your effort?
The idea should not be your execution or tagline. **State in 25 WORDS OR LESS.**

The big idea: to create a nationwide call to buy something to say something.

6. How did you bring the idea to life?

Describe and provide rationale for your communications **strategy** that brought the idea to life. Explain how your idea addresses your challenge. Describe the channels selected, why selected and how they worked together (earned and, if relevant, paid and owned).
In not more than three A4 pages show sufficient creative examples to enable the judges to understand the campaign. These pages can be additional to the eight A4 page written entry.

Listening was the most powerful tactic
Understanding the value of social listening, we were consistently monitoring the news as well as SPC conversations across all social media channels. In the ongoing tide of commentary and rhetoric, one everyday Australian stood out to us.

On Thursday 6th February a Newcastle mum named Linda Drummond tweeted the #SPCSunday hashtag, encouraging her friends to eat SPC on Sunday in support.



Turning a tweet into a lifeline
Linda's tweet provided the perfect opportunity to unlock the power of the positive sentiment for SPC. However, we only had a few days to fuel the initiative that Linda had started. Immediately we set about turning her hashtag

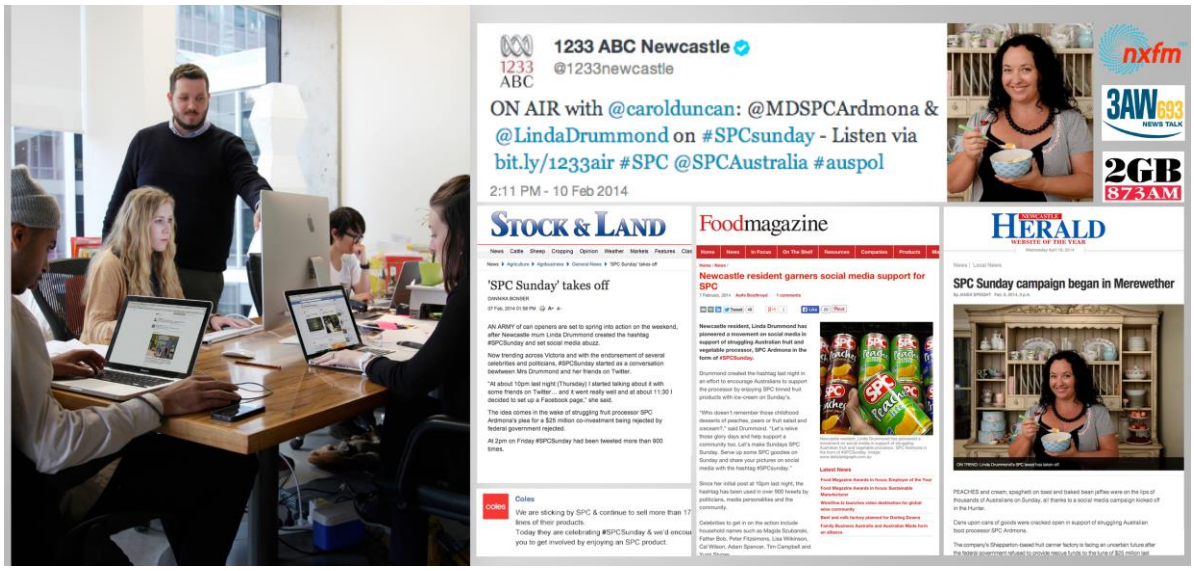
into a nationwide campaign and an Australian success story.

Giving an authentic face and voice to #SPCSunday

We established Linda as the spokesperson, the everyday Australian who embodied a nation's love for SPC. However, this alone was not enough. Our challenge was to amplify her voice and give it impact. The key to success was sticking to the right tone. It had to feel grassroots in its nature and be authentic at all times.

Adopting a more nimble way of working – Adaptive Planning

Adaptive Planning was deployed by utilising our real time social media response team that fed the #SPCSunday conversation and generated SPC branded content. Key influencer outreach and emotive messaging became our prime tactics. We deliberately targeted passionate Australian celebrities with large social followings, advocates of Australian-made produce, prominent retailers such as Coles and Woolworths, and high profile Australians with regional ties, especially those with connections to the Goulburn Valley region – the home of SPC and the fruit growers. Every message was designed to rally the public into a bigger force that couldn't be ignored. The rapid scale and size of the conversation enabled #SPCSunday to become a hot topic for media to cover.



Giving every Australian the chance to be part of something bigger

The execution phase continued non-stop for 96 hours – there could be no lull in keeping the subject alive, as our window to make a difference was slight. The success of the campaign was largely due to the consistent and planned effort to fuel #SPCSunday with hundreds of real-time interactions that touched a patriotic nerve. The emotive language encouraged every Australian to feel like they were part of something bigger: having a hand in saving a much-loved Australian brand.



7. How do you know your campaign was successful?

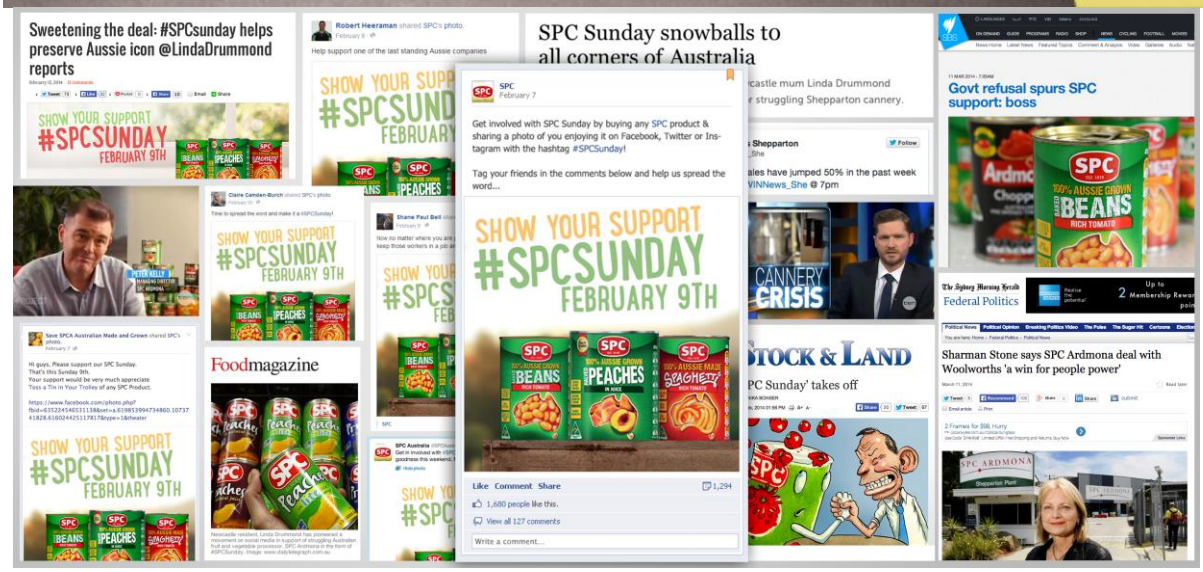
Detail why you consider your effort a success. **Refer to your objectives** (results must relate directly to your objectives in (3) – restate them and provide results) and demonstrate how you met or exceeded those objectives using quantitative and behavioural metrics. For confidential information proof of performance may be indexed if desired. Demonstrate the correlation between activity and outcomes. AVES will not be considered a valid measure and cannot form part of the evaluation process.

Make sure you address every objective, whether fully achieved or not. Indicate why the results you have are significant in the context of your category, competition and product / service.

Reached half the country in four days

The campaign was live for only four days, and in that time #SPCSunday reached half the country, over fourteen million people[5]. The PR and media coverage tallied millions of dollars in earned media, all from a social media investment of just $2,500.

[5] Stock and Land (February 2014). *SPC Sunday reaches 14.6 million*



People documented and shared their efforts to save SPC

It became more than a hashtag – we were seeing evidence of behaviour change via social media that families all over Australia were supporting #SPCSunday and proudly consuming SPC products[6].

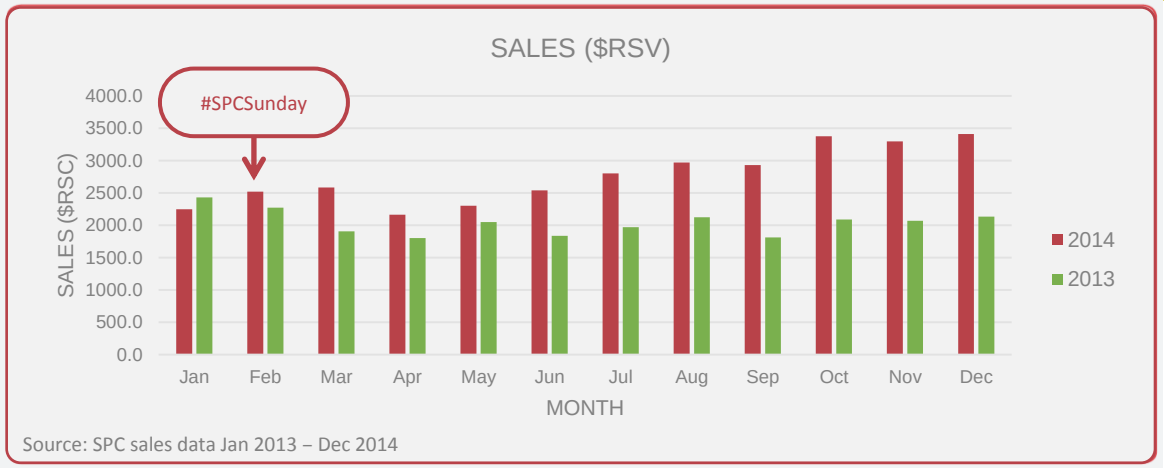


Generated the greatest period of growth in over two years

The activation of #SPCSunday had an astounding impact on sales, short and longer term. Our original objective of halving the monthly rate of decline from $RSV-13.46 to $RSV-6.73, was smashed. Decline was eliminated, as #SPCSunday delivered the longest and greatest period of consistent growth that SPC had experienced in over two years[7].

[6] Radian 6 (February 2014). Social listening research looking at '#SPCSunday'

[7] SPC sales data (2011-2014). Monthly sales figures of SPC Ardmona packaged fruit during and following SPC Sunday (February-June 2014) as compared to monthly sales figures in 2012 & 2013.



Sparked a political shift in SPC's favour

The impressive turnaround in sales and the powerful voice of the people created an interesting position for the Australian Government, who had recently publicly declared not to support SPC. The success of #SPCSunday prompted the Victorian Government to grant SPC a multi million rescue package.

The company also struck a five year deal with Woolworths. An iconic brand saved, along with the fate of thousands of workers in the Goulburn Valley region.

And the best part of all? #SPCSunday lives on. Every Sunday since, Australians continue to show their support. A truly remarkable Australian success story.

#SPCSunday consumer tweets July 2014 – February 2015



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"If customers weren't that fussed about buying Australian-owned, we would be finished. We wouldn't have stayed open if it wasn't for the surge in sales from the consumers, God bless 'em. This is the people speaking.''

Peter Kelly,
Managing Director, SPC. March 2014

Reminder Have you answered all questions and sourced all data, facts and results?

8. Did it achieve a positive ROI?

Provide the cost (total campaign expenditure) per 1000 people reached.

Entries that provide convincing evidence that they also provided a positive financial return will gain additional marks. (Note that this data can be excluded from the published case on request.) We recognise that, in some instances, a measurable financial return will not be an objective, but you will need to persuade the judges why not.

ROI measures by what percentage the incremental gross profit (not gross sales) generated exceeded the campaign costs/investment.

'Incremental' means comparing what happened, with what would be expected to happen had the campaign not taken place and/or that status quo maintained.

So, if the incremental gross profit is $1,000 and campaign costs are $1,000, they cancel each other out and the ROI is 0%. If additional gross profit was $1,500 the ROI is 50%.

(refer to the supplementary notes on ROI calculation)

This is not a typical business case. The goal for SPC was not one of profit, but one of survival. The best chance would be to secure government funding.

#SPCSunday and the overwhelming national support that it rallied, demonstrated to the government that SPC was a company worth saving. As a result, the Victorian Government gave SPC a multi-million dollar rescue grant.

The success of #SPCSunday, however, stretches even further than the survival of the company.

Since #SPCSunday, an additional 7 million Australian households have bought SPC branded fruit products, sparking a sales increase of $10 million. Following three consecutive years of decline, the total SPC brand has grown by $8 million RSV, which marks an unprecedented increase of 12%[8].

Despite a modest investment of just $2,500 in social media, SPC doesn't only survive; it thrives.

9. Convince us that the result was not due to other factors.

You must explain in your entry the effect of any other potentially relevant factors such as product changes, pricing changes, distribution changes, competitive activity, advertising, press coverage, economic conditions, weather etc. You should acknowledge and estimate the role played by other factors and you should advise if the communications program led to other benefits accruing (such as retailers taking on more SKU's, improving space allocated and access to promotional activity, or even improved support from a sales force that has 'increased belief' in the brand). Marketing communications rarely works in isolation but the judges need to be convinced that your campaign had a major impact on results.

Competitive media investment did not reduce

Competitor media spend within the category remained consistent over the campaign period, with total category media investment down by just $10k in the month of February 2014, which is comparative to the same time last year[9].

Competitive prices reduced

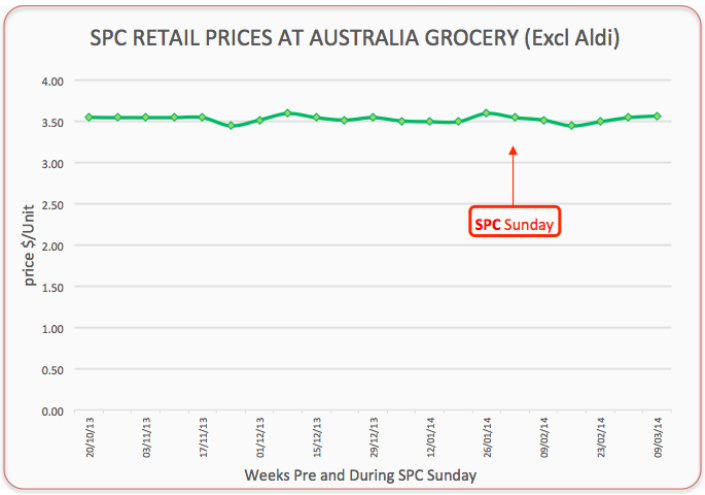
In response to the campaign, Heinz discounted their cans of baked beans to just $1, making them significantly cheaper than SPC baked beans. This reaction heightened the already tough challenge that #SPCSunday had to overcome.

[8] Ongoing SPC household consumption research, national panel.

[9] AQX (January-February 2013 and January-February 2014). Comparison of year on year media spending for Baked Beans and Spaghetti competitors & Canned Fruit competitors

SPC pricing was consistent before and during the campaign

The prices of SPC products remained stable during the course of the #SPCSunday campaign, so price has been removed as a contributing factor[10].



10. Do you think there are any lessons to be learned from this case about advertising effectiveness or measurement?

Judges will give additional marks to exceptional ideas, exceptional results and to cases that teach us something about how advertising works. A big idea is worth more than a lesser idea. A case that adds to our knowledge about advertising effectiveness or measurement deserves additional marks. These marks are open to the discretion of the judges. This is the "I wish I'd been responsible for that" factor. Reward great ideas, great results, originality, innovative measurement techniques. Penalise poorly written cases. High scores here will be the cases we want marketing students to be inspired by; the cases we can learn something from; the cases we want to showcase to the world.

This campaign demonstrates a new way of working when faced with a challenging set of circumstances that will feel all-too familiar for many in the industry today. We didn't have the luxury of time, money or even a client brief. The lesson learnt is that in the absence of all these traditional campaign requirements, you can still drive effectiveness, great enough to save a company from closure, when you relinquish yourself from a traditional planning approach and adopt what we call, Adaptive Planning.

[10] SPC Multiserve Fruit Pricing, Australian Grocery (excl. Aldi) (2013-2014). *Price and tonnes share of total multiserve fruit over time*

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PAYMENT **ABN – 84 140 893 152**

TAX INVOICE/RECEIPT

COST:

TCC & AANA Members: Entries Received By 23 April 2015	$ 950 + GST ($1,045) per entry
TCC & AANA Members: Extended Deadline 7 May 2015	$1,250 + GST ($1,375) per entry
Non-Members: Entries Received By 23 April 2015	$1,750 + GST ($1,925) per entry
Non-Members: Extended Deadline 7 May 2015	$2,050 +GST ($2,255) per entry

PAYMENT OPTIONS:

Cheque:

Cheques to be made payable to and mailed to:

The Communications Council
PO Box Q1389,
QVB Post Office, NSW 1230.

Credit Card:

If paying by credit card please complete the details below and mail or fax this form to The Communications Council**, Fax: (02) 8297 3801.**

Please charge $_____ to Visa ☐ MasterCard ☐ American Express ☐

Card Number: _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ Expiry: _ _ / _ _

Name on Card: _____

Signature: _____

Direct Deposit:

BSB – 032 000 Account Number – 51 5553 Reference – Effie Entry + Agency Name

Remittance advice must be emailed to jo@ communicationscouncil.org.au or faxed to (02) 8297 3801, attention to Jo Libline

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AGENCY AND ADVERTISER AUTHORISATION

SIGNATURE FOR ENTRY BY COMPANY OFFICERS

We certify on behalf of:

_____ (Agency CEO) and _____ (Client Company CEO or equivalent)

that the information submitted for the attached campaign is a true and accurate portrayal of the objectives and results of that campaign.

We also certify that the campaign has not been found in breach of any advertising or marketing codes or in breach of any law within the Australian jurisdiction.

We acknowledge that the case study of this campaign may be published by The Communications Council or with the authorisation of The Communications Council, but that we will have the opportunity to remove such information from that case study that we regard as market sensitive or confidential.

_____
Signature of Officer of Agency

Title:
Company:
Date:

_____
Signature of Officer of Client Company

Title:
Company:
Date:

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